COMMISSION ON HIGHER EDUCATION
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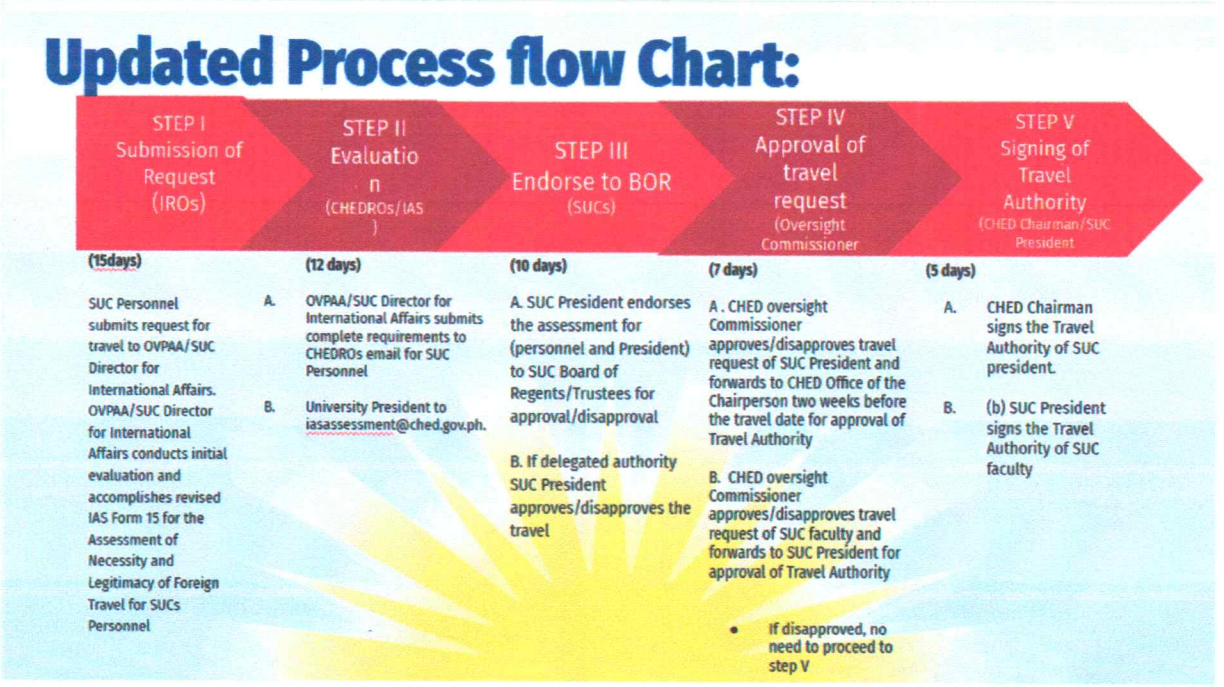
CHED MEMORANDUM ORDER
No. 03
Series of 2025

SUBJECT: **UPDATED GUIDELINES FOR SECURING AUTHORITY TO TRAVEL ABROAD FOR STATE UNIVERSITIES AND COLLEGES (SUCs)**

Pursuant to Executive Order No. 77 s. 2019 entitled "Prescribing Rules and Regulations and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official Local and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel"and related issuances on local and foreign travels of government officials and personnel the updated guidelines is hereby issued:

1. STATUS OF APPLICATIONS

Hereunder is the revised process flow on the updated procedure and corresponding timelines for securing authority to travel abroad for SUC presidents/personnel.



Applications for travel assessment may be checked at <https://bit.ly/SUCstogo>

2. APPLICATION FOR FOREIGN TRAVEL ASSESSMENT

The International Relations Officers (IROs) shall submit the completed Form 15 along with the following required application documents:

a. Cover letter signed by the SUC President, VPAA, or IRO
b. Completed IAS Form 15 (Annex B) <https://bit.ly/IASForm15AnnexB>
c. Invitation/Acceptance Letter
d. Profile or background information of the organizers

The application for foreign travel assessment including the required documents shall be submitted via their official email addresses to the responsible CHED Regional Offices (CHEDROs) using the respective official CHEDRO email addresses listed below.

CHED Regional Office	Official Email
CHED NCR	transnational.ncr@ched.gov.ph
CHED CAR	chedcar@ched.gov.ph
CHED CARAGA	chedcaraga@ched.gov.ph
CHED MIMAROPA	chedro4b@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region I	chedro1@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region II	chedro2@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region III	chedro3@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region IV	chedro4a@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region V	chedro5@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region VI	chedro6@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region VII	chedro7@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region VIII	chedro8@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region IX	chedro9@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region X	chedro10@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region XI	chedro11@ched.gov.ph
CHED Region XII	chedro12@ched.gov.ph

3. ROLE OF THE INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS OFFICE (IRO)

The respective International Relations Officers (IROs) or designated officials responsible for international affairs and internationalization of the concerned SUCs shall accomplish the 2024 revised (International Affairs Service) IAS Form 15. Part I of the Revised Assessment of Necessity and Legitimacy of Foreign Travel for SUCs Personnel. The IRO shall likewise ensure that the requested travel abroad is aligned with SUC's Strategic Internationalization Plan (SIP) and that all requirements under EO 77 S. 2019 and related travel issuances are faithfully complied with.

4. FORM 15 (EVALUATION FORM FOR THE CRITERIA AND NECESSITY OF FOREIGN TRAVEL FOR STATE UNIVERSITIES AND COLLEGES)

The revised IAS Form 15 provides information needed by CHED to evaluate the travel request. Said form was developed for SUCs to indicate all relevant information and to meet the criteria on official travels, in compliance with the provisions of Executive Order 77 Series of 2019, particularly:

a. It is essential to the effective performance of an official or employee's mandates or functions;
b. It is required to meet the needs of the department, agency, bureau or office, or there is substantial benefit to be derived by the State;
c. The presence of the official or employee is critical to the outcome of the meeting, conference seminar, consultation or any official activity to be attended;
d. The projected expenses are not excessive or involve minimum expenditure. (Section 3 E.O. 77 S. 2019)

5. TOOLKIT ON DETERMINING RED-FLAGGED CONFERENCES AND ORGANISATIONS

To guide IROs in determining the legitimacy of conferences , enclosed herein are the criteria for red-flagged conferences and organizations by looking at the toolkit given by the CHED-IAS link: <https://bit.ly/toolkit_for_SUCs>.

This Toolkit will be constantly updated for the guidance of the higher education sector.

6. **FOREIGN TRAVEL REQUESTS INVOLVING SUC PRESIDENTS/OFFICERS-IN-CHARGE**

   a. For travel requests involving SUC Presidents/Officers-in-Charge, Form 15 and required documents listed in No. 2 above shall be submitted by the IRO through iasassessment@ched.gov.ph.

   b. Requests of the SUC President must be submitted one month prior to the date of departure.

   c. SUC President in Benchmarking and partnership visit, should submit a confirmation letter from the host university with an official program stipulating a formal meeting between the Presidents of both institutions.

   d. SUCs officials who are part of the President of the Philippines' official travel shall observe the requirements of Memorandum Circular No. 50 S. 2024.

   e. As a way of performance monitoring to measure the impact of the President's and key officials' international travels on the institution's internationalization progress by the Office of the CHED Chairman, report on the subject travel be submitted to the link https://bit.ly/OnlineTravelMonitoring within thirty (30) days after the SUCs officials return from travel pursuant to Section XXI of CHED Administrative Order No. 4, s. 2019. SUCs officials may further use the said link to submit updates on the travel mission outputs like joint research projects, increased international student enrollment, reforms on institutional policies/programs/projects or enhanced institutional reputation. By adhering to this practice, university presidents can ensure that international travels yield measurable and meaningful outcomes that justify the use of public funds, while promoting responsible financial stewardship and advancing the global competitiveness of Philippine HEIs. Failure to provide timely information on SUC officials concluded missions and updates thereto may affect the assessment of their succeeding requests for authority to travel.

7. **REPORTS ON TRAVEL ABROAD.**

   International Relations Officers (IROs) must ensure that participants submit a travel a report month after the scheduled travel instead of the scheduled quarter meeting as the same would be too long and to also align with the existing rules and regulations of the Commission on Audit (COA), take into account that there might be another invitation/official travel before the scheduled trip.

8. TRAVEL JUNKETS ARE PROHIBITED

All forms of travel junkets are strictly prohibited as stipulated in Section 19 of EO 77 S. 2019. As such, the specific roles and responsibilities of all participants must be clearly defined in accordance with government guidelines to ensure smooth coordination and compliance with Executive Order 77 S. 2019.

9. TRIPS PARTIALLY OR FULLY SPONSORED BY PRIVATE CORPORATIONS OR PRIVATE INDIVIDUALS WITH PENDING REQUESTS WITH SUCs ARE PROHIBITED.

At all times Section 20 of E.O. 77 s. 2019 must be strictly observed which requires all foreign trips partially or fully sponsored by private corporations or private individuals shall be fully disclosed. Furthermore, no official or personal travel of government officials and employees shall be funded directly or indirectly, fully or partially by the private individuals, including suppliers or contractors, with pending request/s or application/s or future dealings with any branch, department, bureau or office of the National Government of local government units concerned. This prohibition applies to invitations to travel purportedly to undertake study or assessment of the proponents' capabilities as such contractors/ suppliers. (Section 20, EO 77, S. 2019)

10. EXEMPTIONS TO TRAVEL CLEARANCE

The following travel shall be exempted from securing CHED travel assessment:

a. CHED funded projects.
b. IAS endorsed activities/events.
c. Funded by recognized local and international sponsoring agencies or institutions (i.e.USAID, DOST, DTI, DA, DOLE, etc). However, the accountability for the said travel shall be with the sponsoring agency.
d. Paper presentations provided that SUCs have internal policy on quality control for papers presented internationally (i.e. in house review, part of university R&D agenda, GAA funded research).
e. Participation in trainings, workshops, conferences as an offshoot of MOU/MOA registered in the Registry of Linkages of Philippine Higher Education Institutions <https://bit.ly/RegistryofLinkages>.
f. Foreign travel as a follow-through action or implementation of the areas of collaboration specified in the MOA/MOU with a partner-agency or institution, which has been previously cleared/endorsed by CHEDROs/IAS.Provided that previous travels are promptly reported in the

Office of the CHED Chairman's monitoring link https://bit.ly/OnlineTravelMonitoring.

g. Personal Travels of SUC Personnel. At no instance will the personnel represent themselves in official capacity when on personal leave. However, the Office of the University President must provide a certification confirming that an Officer-in-Charge will be designated during the period of personal travel, ensuring the continuity of operations within the Office of the University President.

Travel requests for more than two officials/personnel are required to submit to CHED-IAS/CHEDROs, Form 15 and other documents to ensure that E.O. 77 s. 2019 is observed.

11. TRANSITORY PROVISIONS

From the signing of this CMO, CHED-IAS shall oversee a seamless transition in the transfer of functions to the CHEDROs on the processing of application for travel of SUCs officials and personnel other than the President/OIC. This includes conducting orientation sessions and capacitating the designated international focal persons on the processes outlined herein. These activities shall be completed within three (3) months from the date of signing. Thereafter the full transfer of functions to the CHEDROs shall be implemented.

12. REPEALING CLAUSE

All provisions in previous CHED issuances inconsistent or in conflict with this CMO are hereby deemed repealed.

13. SEPARABILITY CLAUSE

If any part or provision in this CMO is declared invalid the remaining clauses/provisions not affected thereby shall remain valid and enforceable.

14. EFFECTIVITY

This CMO shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its publication in the Official Gazette or newspaper of general circulation, and after filing required copies thereof with the Office of National Administrative Registrar (ONAR) at the U.P. Law Center, U.P. Diliman, Quezon City and shall remain in force and effect until revoked or amended.

Signed this 17th day of March 2025 in Quezon City, Philippines.

For the Commission:

SGD.
J. PROSPERO E. DE VERA III, DPA
Chairman

Annex B
REVISED IAS FORM 15 (2025)

COMMISSION ON HIGHER EDUCATION

ASSESSMENT OF NECESSITY AND LEGITIMACY OF FOREIGN TRAVEL FOR SUCS PERSONNEL FORM

I. To be filled out by SUC IRO:

Title of Travel: _____
Name of Organizer: _____
Date of Event: _____
Duration of Travel (inclusive of travel time) : _____ **days**
Venue / Country: _____
Mode of Event: [ ] **Face to Face** [ ] **Online** [ ] **Hybrid**
Number of Participant/s: [ ] **Official/s** [ ] **Faculty/Staff** [ ] **Student/s**
Name of Attendee: _____ **Designation:** _____ **Age:** _____ ***Gender:** _____
If with delegation or more than one (1) participant, please use Annex A for List of Participants

A. Evaluation of the Necessity of Foreign Travel:	**Considerations / Remarks**
1. The purpose of the trip is strictly within the mandate of the requesting official or employee. **[ ] Yes** **[ ] No**	Indicate Mandate of SUC Personnel: ***(Do not leave blank)***
2. The trip is expected to bring substantial benefit to the country. **[ ] Yes** **[ ] No**	**Indicate Measurable Return of Investments to be derived from this trip:** Programs: Projects: Policies: Partnerships: Others:
3. The presence of the official or employee is critical to the outcome of the meeting, conference, seminar, consultation or any official activity to be attended **[ ] Yes** **[ ] No**	**Indicate Role of Attendee/Justification:** ***(Do not leave blank)***
4. **The trip's projected expenses are not excessive and in accordance with the ff. issuances:** -EO 298 s. 2004 *"Amending Further Executive Order No. 248 Dated May 29, 1995 as Amended by Executive Order No. 248-A Dated August 14, 1995, Which Prescribes Rules and Regulations and New Rates of Allowances for Official Local and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel"* - Section 8 of EO 298 s. 2004 on UNDP Index -Chapter 5 *"Travel Expenses"* of the *"Training Handbook on Government Expenditures" (2011)"* -Title II of EO No. 77 s. 2019 *(i.e. pre-departure expenses not exceeding Php3,500, economy class transportation expenses, etc.)* *-CHED CAO 04 s. 2019* **[ ] Yes** **[ ] No**	**Estimated total amount of expenses per participant:** ***(Do not leave blank. Indicate N/A if Not Applicable)***
5. **Source of funding** *(in accordance with the ff. issuances:* *-EO No. 248 dated May 29, 1995, as amended by EO 248-A dated August 14, 1995, and EO 298 dated March 23, 2004, prescribing rules and regulations and new rates of allowances for official local and foreign travels of government personnel"* *-Memorandum Circular No. 35 s. 2017, Clarifying and Reinforcing Existing Rules and Regulations on Foreign Travel Authorities, Travel Entitlements, and Travel Tax Exemptions, which require the approval of the office of the president)*	**Source:** [ ] SUC Internal Fund [ ] Funded by Organizer / Grant [ ] Personal Funding of Participant/s (on official time) Others:_____ **Provisions:** [ ] Airfare [ ] Meals [ ] Accommodation [ ] Incidental Expenses [ ] Pre-departure Expenses [ ] Registration/ Participation Fee
6. Submitted Comprehensive Report for Previous Travel (Do not leave blank) Link to submitted travel report:_____	**[ ] Complied** **[ ] Not Complied** **[ ] N/A**

B. Alignment to SUC's Strategic Internationalization Plan (SIP):	
1. SUC has a Board Approved Strategic Internationalization Plan (SIP)	**[ ] Yes** **[ ] No**
2. Explain briefly how participation in this activity aligns with SUC's Strategic Internationalization Plan (SIP) **(DO NOT LEAVE BLANK)**	
3. **Value of the travel or mission**	**(Check that all apply)** [ ] Capacitate SUC Personnel [ ] Support international reputation of PHEI [ ] Build possible linkage/s and collaboration International Commitment: [ ] is a member-institution [ ] is signatory [ ] is part of the negotiation or agreements Potential Partners: [ ] International Organizations [ ] Academic Institutions [ ] Professional Institutions [ ] Research Institutes [ ] Government Entities [ ] Private Entities
4. **If engagement implements an existing agreement, please indicate details of the partnership:** *(Indicate N/A if not applicable)*	**Title of Agreement:**
	Parties:
	Date Signed:
5. Existing Agreement has been reported to CHED IAS **[ ] Yes** **[ ] No**	If **NO**, please submit signed agreement to the IAS Registry of Linkage at https://forms.gle/nkHybxuWBcFskGdD8
6. Certification by Concerned Department on the Legitimacy of the Event. **Link to signed certification:_____** **(Please see attached template)**	Remarks: Link of sample SUC Certification to fill and sign by Concerned Department
7. Attendee/Participant has submitted Re-entry Action Plan (REAP). **(Annex D of CHED Administrative Order No. 04 S. 2019)** [ ] Yes [ ] No Link to submitted Re-entry Action Plan (REAP):_____	Link sample of Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP)

Evaluated by:

[NAME]
(Designation)
HEI Officer responsible for coordinating, facilitating and leading the implementation of international agreements, commitments and Internationalization programs

Recommending Approval:

[NAME]
SUC President

* assigned at birth

II. To be filled out by CHED:

Reference No.:_____

A. Completeness of Submitted Documentary Requirements	
Checklist: [ ] Cover letter signed by SUC President/VPAA/IRO [ ] Invitation Letter / Acceptance Letter [ ] Profile of the Organizer [ ] Duly accomplished IAS Form 15 (revised 2024)	Remarks: *Complete / Incomplete*
B. Evaluation of Legitimacy	
Nature of Travel / Activity to be Attended: [ ] International Conference - Paper and Oral Presentation [ ] Meeting [ ] MOA/MOU Signing [ ] Scholarship, Training, or Study Abroad [ ] Student Exchange / Mobility Program [ ] Faculty Exchange / Mobility Program [ ] Others:_____	Remarks: *Legitimate / Questionable*
Nature of Organizer /Sponsoring /Inviting Body: [ ] International Organization [ ] Academic Institution Recognized/Accredited by: [ ] Ministry of Education (MOE) [ ] Authorized Accrediting Body [ ] Professional Organization / Association [ ] Government Entity [ ] Private Entity [ ] Others:_____	Remarks: *Legitimate / Questionable*
Event / Activity is sanctioned/endorsed by CHED: **[ ] Yes [ ] No**	Remarks:
Event / Activity is aligned with SUC's SIP: **[ ] Yes [ ] No**	Remarks:
Other Factors: [ ] Red flags were observed about the organizer and international conference [ ] Event is organized by a local association/organizer held abroad [ ] Role of delegation members are unclear [ ] Participation to the activity is not within the personnel's mandate [ ] Personnel not eligible to travel due to age per CSC rule Section 18 (d) of General Provisions Fiscal Year 2024 [ ] Alignment to SIP is unclear [ ] Travel is covered by Sec. 19 of EO No. 77 S. 2019 on Prohibition against Junkets of Government Officials and Employees [ ] Sponsoring body is a private entity (Sec. 20 of EO No. 77 S. 2019) [ ] Failure to comply with submission of comprehensive report for previous travel [ ] Failure to comply with submission of REAP (Sec 8 of CAO 04. S. 2019)	Remarks:
C. CHED INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS SERVICE EVALUATION RESULT / RECOMMENDATION	
[ ] Recommended for Board Approval	Remarks:
[ ] Not Recommended	

Approved by: (FOR SUC PERSONNEL)

REGIONAL DIRECTOR
Director IV
(CHED REGIONAL OFFICE)

Approved by: (FOR UNIVERSITY PRESIDENT)

ATTY. LILY FREIDA M. MILLA, CESO III
OIC-Deputy Executive Director IV
Director, International AFfairs Service

COMMISSION ON HIGHER EDUCATION

ASSESSMENT OF NECESSITY AND LEGITIMACY OF FOREIGN TRAVEL FOR SUCS PERSONNEL FORM

Annex A - List of Participants / Members of Delegation

Instructions: *Use this form for more than one (1) SUC personnel participating/attending in the international event. Please note that pursuant to the Executive Order No. 77 S. 2019,* ***number of participants in trips involving delegation must be kept to the barest minimum.***

	Name	Age	Gender	Designation	Mandate	Justification for participation in the activity
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						

* Assigned at birth